TLE: Talented & Gifted Services & ACCESS



PORTLAND
Public Schools

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Identification of TAG Students

Summary of Division 22 Requirements:

- The district is required to have a plan for identification of academically talented and intellectually gifted students.
- Students eligible for TAG identification meet the following criteria:
  1) Demonstrate exceptional performance when compared to applicable developmental or learning progressions; and
  2) Require differentiated instructional services and/or programs designed to address their strengths and needs.

Identification of TAG Students

Corrective Action

- The district must **provide annual training** for all licensed staff on identifying students for TAG services.
- The district must **track and keep data** on all licensed staff who have been trained and on the number of students identified each year.
- The district must provide the training information as part of a publicly posted **annual report** to ODE and the complainant.

PPS Procedures

Universal screening is administered to all 1st grade students and all ELD newcomer students through a nonverbal assessment.

The PPS TAG Identification process meets all requirements of Division 22, and:

- May be submitted by the family, any school staff, or the student at any time during the school year (or triggered by universal screening);
- Includes information from the student's family and teacher;
- Requires a determination be made by the school TAG team (administrator + TAG Facilitator).

Identification of TAG Students

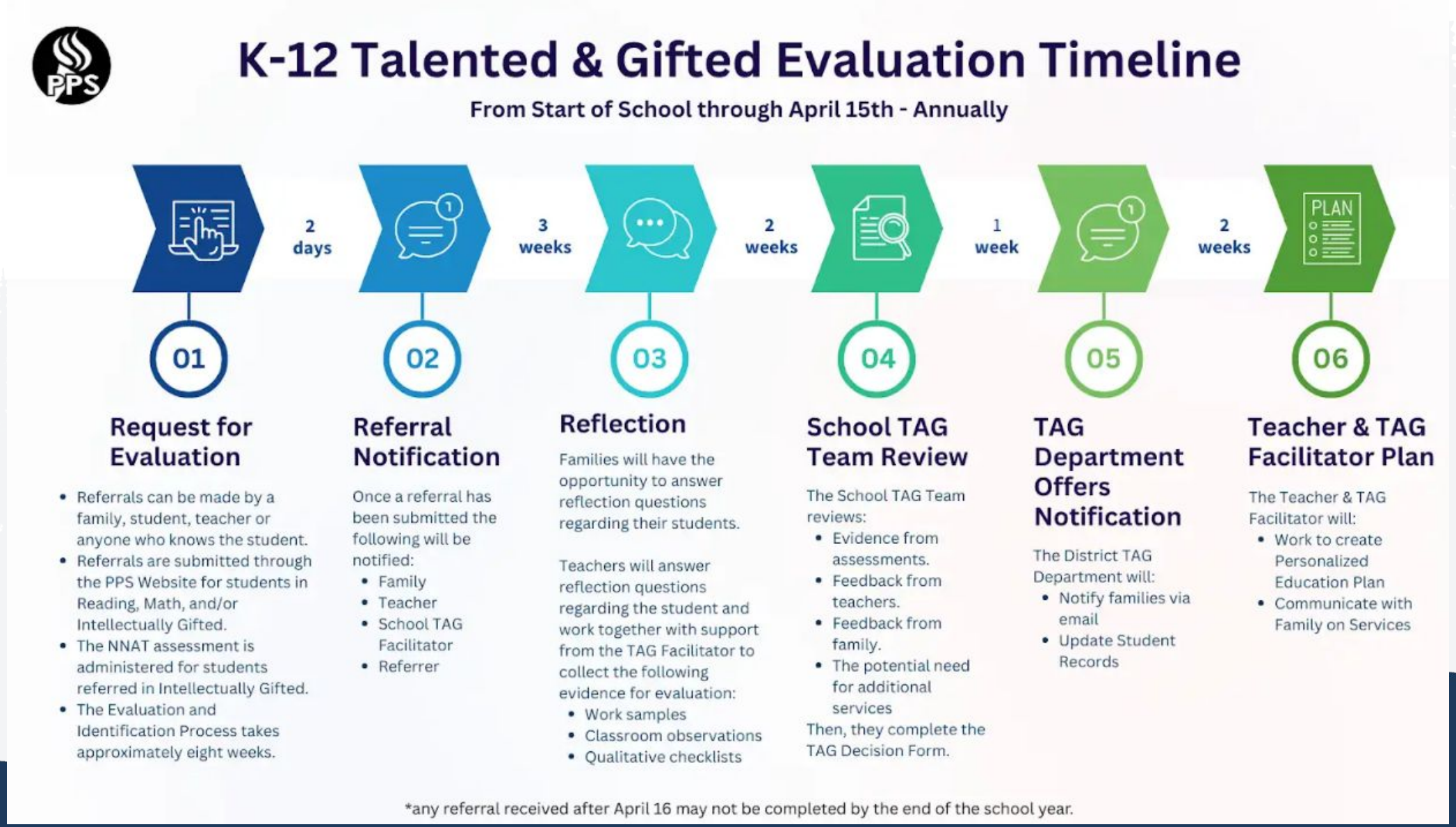
Data (2025-2026)

Licensed Staff Trained in Identification & Services (12/1/25): 2,520 (75.7%)

Population	Percent of Population Identified for TAG Services*
American Indian / Alaskan Native	5%
Asian	16%
Black / African American	4%
Latino	9%
Multi-Racial	21%
Native Hawaiian / Other Pacific Islander	2%
White	26%

Number of Areas Identified	Count	Percent
Identified in one area	4,298	56%
Identified in two areas	2,241	29%
Identified in all areas	1,136	15%
Total Unique Students Identified	**7,675**	19%
Total Unique Identifications	**12,269**	

Identification of TAG Students



Programs and Services for TAG Students

Summary of Division 22 Requirements:

- Develop and maintain a written TAG plan, including a description of the programs and services the district will provide.
- Provide appropriately differentiated instruction to identified TAG students that is designed to accommodate their assessed learning levels and accelerated learning rates.
- TAG services must be equitable and responsive, with instruction reflecting the student's unique rate and level of learning.

Programs and Services for TAG Students

Corrective Action

- The district must **provide annual training** for all licensed staff on instructional practices to address TAG-identified students' rate and level.
- The district must ensure that **district administrators have opportunities to observe rate and level** instructional practices.
- The district must **track and keep data** on all licensed staff who have been trained.
- The district must provide the training information as part of a publicly posted **annual report** to ODE and the complainant.

PPS Procedures

- Personalized Education Plans (PEPs) may be requested by parents and are encouraged for all newly identified TAG students.
- TAG services are largely provided in the classroom through differentiated instruction and course selection (HS).
- Services to address the needs of TAG-identified students are more akin to an IEP/504 plan than a separate academic program.

This slide is a part of our PPS Annual TAG Training for Licensed Staff

Providing TAG Services

In order to plan for providing services to TAG students, consider:

Content

- **What are the learning targets and success criteria?**
- **What should students already know? What connections could students make?**
- **Use a Unit Unpacking Protocol to support this piece**

Specific Needs of TAG Students

- **Based on your experience with the student or their Personalized Education Plan, what additional needs do your TAG students have for this content area?**

Implementation

- **Explore the curricular resources to support student needs (see examples on next slide)**
- **Provide opportunities for students to engage in content**
- **Monitor and adjust as needed**

Examples of TAG Services in PPS

This slide is a part of our PPS Annual TAG Training for Licensed Staff

In the classroom:

- Higher Level Thinking and Questioning
- Differentiated Assignments
- Cluster Grouping/Flexible Grouping
- Extension/Application Activities
- Individual Instruction
- Independent Study

District/School Processes & Programs (not limited to TAG students):

- Acceleration (Whole Grade / Subject Area)
- High School Advanced Coursework (AP/IB/Dual Credit)
- ACCESS Academy Program

Personalized Education Plans (PEP)

This slide is a part of our PPS Annual TAG Training for Licensed Staff

Student Personalized Education Plans

- Template is available on the PPS TAG Website
- Families have the right to request a plan
- Based on student strengths, documented needs, and learning goals
- Describe the specific services in the classroom or school that will address the student's needs for appropriate rate and level of learning
- Are shared with the TAG office and uploaded into Synergy as a document on the student's profile
- Reach out to your building TAG Facilitator for support

Rights of Parents of TAG Students

Summary of Division 22 Requirements:

- Inform parents at the time of the identification of the child and the programs and services available.
- Provide an opportunity for the parents to provide input to and discuss with the district the programs and services to be received by their child.
- Notify parents of their rights to withdraw from TAG services and to file a complaint.

Rights of Parents of TAG Students

Corrective Action

- The district must **provide a slide deck** to use during back-to-school nights with information on TAG programs and services, rate and level instructional practices, PEPs, and other opportunities.
- Develop a plan for proactively communicating with families that PEPs are available to TAG students.

PPS Procedures

- The TAG Department communicates with families going through TAG identification, including:
  - Opportunities for family input;
  - Notification of the TAG determination and appeal process; and
  - Services available to students.
- Centrally provided training to TAG Facilitators on the PEP process, including family collaboration.
- Annual communication to families with information on timelines and processes is shared through district and school level communication streams.

ACCESS Academy

Program Description:

- ACCESS Academy is a program for students in grades 2-8 who need accelerated instruction.
- It operates as part of the district's offerings for gifted education, providing a distinct option for students whose learning needs exceed what a traditional neighborhood school can provide.
- ACCESS offers instruction based on students' abilities/achievement rather than strictly by chronological age or grade level.

ACCESS Academy

Admission

- Eligible 2nd-8th grade students are admitted through the PPS Enrollment and Transfer lottery process.
- All students must meet eligibility criteria.
- The lottery process includes weighting for economically disadvantaged students and siblings of current students (who meet eligibility criteria).
- The TAG Department is responsible for determining the eligibility criteria.

Student Demographics 2025-2026

Student Subgroup	# Students	% of Students
Total	325	100.0%
Female	111	34.2%
Male	203	62.5%
Non Binary	11	3.4%
Asian	19	5.8%
Black	3	.9%
Latino	25	7.7%
Multiple	48	14.8%
Pac Isl	2	.6%
White	228	70.2%
ELL	1	.3%
SPED	40	12.3%

Contact us

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